

Dangerous turn: On Trump and the Ukraine war

Trump must **stay the course on diplomacy** to end the Ukraine war

President Donald Trump's **announcement** that he has ordered "two nuclear **submarines** to be **positioned** in appropriate regions", in response to the "**provocative** statements" by former Russian President Dmitry Medvedev, **marks** a dangerous turn in the U.S.-Russia relationship which the Republican leader had **pledged** to repair **in the run-up to** his election late last year. **Mr. Medvedev**, now the Deputy Chairman of Russia's Security Council, **had** said that Mr. Trump's **threats** of **imposing tariffs** on Russia **were** "a step towards war". Mr. Trump did not specify whether he has moved submarines capable of launching intercontinental ballistic missiles with nuclear warheads, or nuclear-powered boats **equipped with conventional** weapons. In recent weeks, Mr. Trump has expressed growing **frustration** with his Russian **counterpart** Vladimir Putin over the Ukraine war. Initially, he gave Mr. Putin a 50-day deadline to end the war or face American tariffs. On July 29, this was shortened to 10 to 12 days. Mr. Trump has also threatened secondary "penalty" tariffs on countries that trade with Russia such as India and China.

Mr. Trump's frustration is understandable. He pressured Ukraine into accepting a **ceasefire** proposal. His Defence Secretary publicly **stated** that Ukraine would not be taken into NATO. Yet, the most that he **managed** to extract from Mr. Putin was a limited **truce** in the Black Sea and a temporary pause in attacks on Ukrainian **infrastructure**. **At the heart of** the **impasse** are the **divergent** views in western capitals and Moscow on how to end the war. While western leaders **insist on** an immediate ceasefire, Moscow believes that this should be part of a **comprehensive** peace agreement **addressing** its core security concerns, including NATO's eastward expansion. Russia also finds little **incentive** to **de-escalate** at a time when its troops have strategic **momentum**. **Ukraine** has **carried out** deadly drone attacks on several Russian cities, but on the battlefield, **is** struggling to **hold the line**. Besides, Mr. Trump's **decision** to bomb Iran on behalf of Israel, at a time when Tehran was technically in talks with the U.S., **appears** to have hardened Russia's position. **Nevertheless**, diplomatic **setbacks** are not an excuse for nuclear **sabre-rattling**. The last thing the world wants today is a direct conflict between the U.S. and Russia. Instead of **escalating** the crisis, Mr. Trump must **reflect on** why America's current **approach** — combining sanctions against Russia with military support for Ukraine — **has** failed to **deter** Mr. Putin. His initial **turn** towards diplomacy **was** a **step in the right direction**. He must stay the course and narrow the gap between the western and Russian positions on ending the war.

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

[Practice Exercise]

Vocabulary

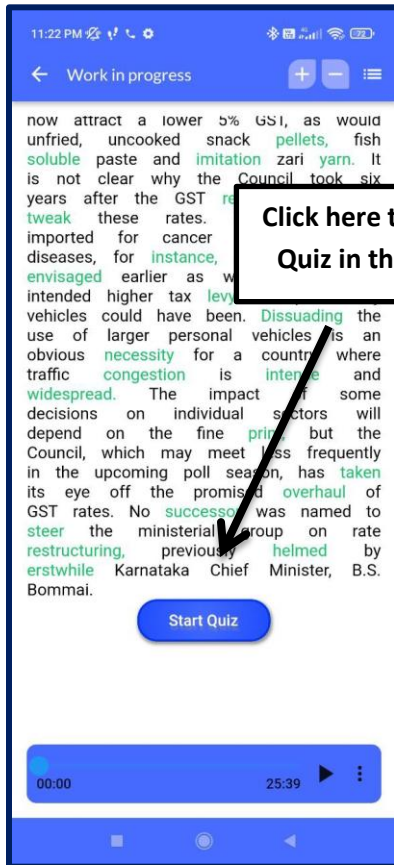
1. **Stay the course on** (phrase) – persist, continue, endure, persevere, stick with डटे रहना
2. **Diplomacy** (noun) – negotiation, tact, foreign policy, mediation, discussion कूटनीति
3. **Submarine** (noun) – underwater vessel, U-boat, naval craft, submersible, warship पनडुब्बी
4. **Position** (verb) – place, deploy, arrange, station, align तैनात करना
5. **Provocative** (adjective) – inflammatory, inciting, aggravating, challenging, annoying उकसाने वाला
6. **Mark** (verb) – signify, indicate, represent, denote, symbolize चिह्नित करना
7. **Pledge** (verb) – promise, vow, commit, swear, guarantee वचन देना
8. **In the run-up to** (phrase) – prior to, before, leading up to, approaching, preceding से पहले के समय में
9. **Impose** (verb) – enforce, levy, apply, dictate, implement थोपना / लागू करना
10. **Tariff** (noun) – tax, duty, levy, charge, customs शुल्क
11. **Equip** (with) (verb) – furnish, arm, outfit, provide, supply लैस करना
12. **Conventional** (adjective) – traditional, standard, normal, customary, routine पारंपरिक
13. **Frustration** (noun) – annoyance, irritation, dissatisfaction, disappointment, exasperation निराशा
14. **Counterpart** (noun) – equivalent, opposite number, peer, fellow, match समकक्ष
15. **Ceasefire** (noun) – truce, armistice, suspension of hostilities, peace, stand-down युद्धविराम
16. **State** (verb) – declare, announce, express, say, communicate कहना / घोषित करना
17. **Manage** (to) (verb) – succeed, achieve, accomplish, pull off, attain सफल होना
18. **Truce** (noun) – ceasefire, armistice, peace agreement, pause, settlement संधि / अस्थायी युद्धविराम
19. **Infrastructure** (noun) – framework, facilities, foundation, support system, base अवसंरचना
20. **At the heart of** (phrase) – central to, at the core of, main issue, foundation of, key part मुख्य बिंदु पर
21. **Impasse** (noun) – deadlock, stalemate, standoff, gridlock, dead end गतिरोध

22. **Divergent** (adjective) – differing, conflicting, contrary, contrasting, dissimilar
अलग-अलग
23. **Insist** (on) (verb) – demand, emphasize, maintain, assert, urge जोर देना
24. **Comprehensive** (adjective) – complete, thorough, all-inclusive, extensive, full
व्यापक
25. **Address** (verb) – deal with, resolve, tackle, confront, handle समाधान करना
26. **Incentive** (noun) – motivation, stimulus, encouragement, inducement, enticement
प्रोत्साहन
27. **De-escalate** (verb) – reduce, diminish, lessen, ease, calm down तनाव कम करना
28. **Momentum** (noun) – drive, thrust, propulsion, impetus, force गति / बढ़त
29. **Carry out** (phrasal verb) – execute, implement, perform, conduct, accomplish
अंजाम देना
30. **Hold the line** (phrase) – resist, stand firm, maintain position, defend, not retreat
स्थिति बनाए रखना
31. **Nevertheless** (adverb) – however, still, yet, nonetheless, even so फिर भी
32. **Setback** (noun) – obstacle, hindrance, defeat, problem, reversal बाधा / झटका
33. **Sabre-rattling** (noun) – threat, show of force, intimidation, war-mongering, aggression युद्ध की धमकी
34. **Escalate** (verb) – intensify, increase, heighten, aggravate, worsen बढ़ाना / तेज़ करना
35. **Reflect** (on) (verb) – think over, consider, contemplate, ponder, review विचार करना
36. **Deter** (verb) – discourage, prevent, dissuade, restrain, inhibit रोकना
37. **Step in the direction** (phrase) – progress, advancement, move forward, positive action, headway सही दिशा में कदम

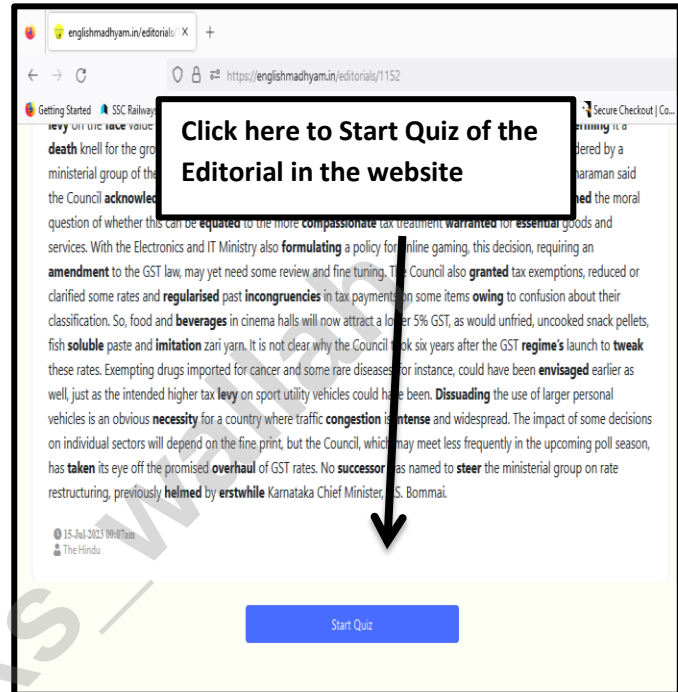
Summary of the Editorial

1. President Trump's decision to deploy two nuclear submarines in response to Russian provocation marks a dangerous escalation in U.S.-Russia tensions.
2. The move came after Dmitry Medvedev (Russia's former president) called Trump's tariff threats a "step towards war."
3. Trump did not clarify if the submarines were nuclear-armed or conventionally armed, adding ambiguity to the threat.
4. Initially elected on promises to repair ties with Russia, Trump is now facing growing frustration with Putin over the Ukraine war.
5. Trump gave Russia a 50-day deadline to end the war, later shortened to 10–12 days, failing to achieve results.
6. He also threatened secondary tariffs on countries trading with Russia, including India and China.
7. Though Trump pressured Ukraine into accepting a ceasefire, and ruled out NATO membership for Ukraine, Putin only offered a limited truce.
8. Russia paused attacks in the Black Sea, but broader military operations and infrastructure strikes continued.
9. A core reason for the deadlock is the mismatch between Western and Russian expectations on how to end the war.
10. The West seeks an immediate ceasefire, while Russia demands a comprehensive deal addressing its security concerns like NATO expansion.
11. Russia currently holds strategic momentum, giving it little incentive to de-escalate, especially as Ukraine struggles militarily.
12. Ukraine has conducted drone attacks on Russian cities, but is failing to hold ground on the frontlines.
13. Trump's airstrikes on Iran, supposedly to support Israel, damaged U.S.-Iran diplomacy and further hardened Russia's stance.
14. The editorial warns that nuclear brinkmanship is irresponsible and global leaders must avoid direct U.S.-Russia confrontation.
15. Trump is urged to recommit to diplomacy, as sanctions and threats alone have failed; narrowing the U.S.-Russia gap is essential for peace.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



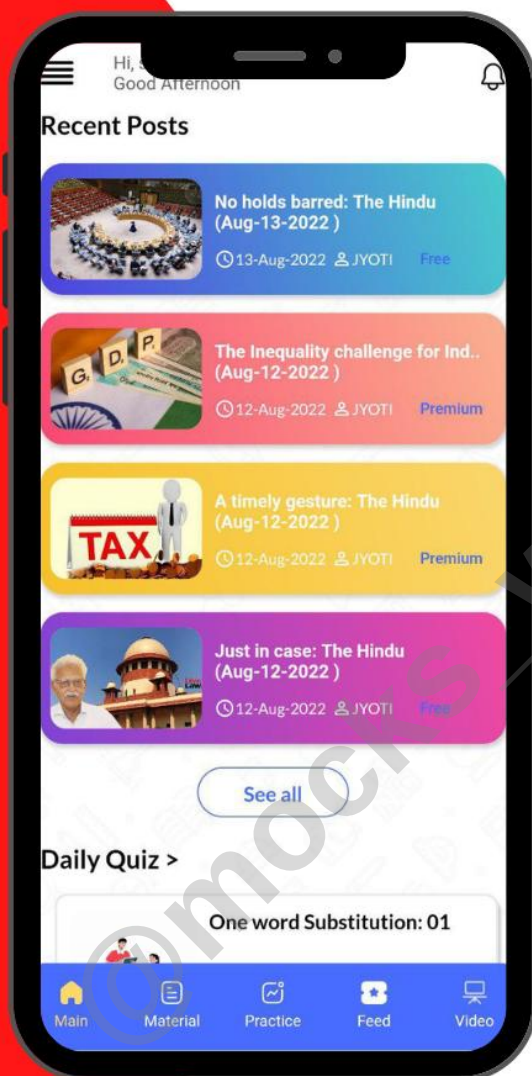
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